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WEEKENDER



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Courtesy: Dubai Media Office

MOHAMMAD VISITS ARABIAN TRAVEL MARKET

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, toured the Arabian Travel Market (ATM) 2025, which concluded yesterday at the Dubai World Trade Centre. He noted that the participation of 166 countries and 55,000 travel and tourism professionals at ATM 2025 highlights the UAE's growing presence on the global tourism map and the rising confidence in its contributions to this vital sector. He also pointed to the strong performance of the tourism industry, which welcomed a record 30.7 million international visitors in 2024, with total spending reaching around Dh250 billion.

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UAE to lift three-year ban on citizens' travel to Lebanon

Abu Dhabi Fund for Development to send a delegation to Lebanon

DUBAI

The UAE will lift a ban on its citizens travelling to Lebanon that was imposed in 2021, according to a joint statement yesterday.

The decision was announced a day after President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan met with Lebanese President Joseph Aoun in Abu Dhabi.

"The two sides agreed to allow citizens to travel after taking necessary measures to facilitate movement between the two countries and putting in place appropriate mechanisms," the statement said.

In 2021, the UAE imposed a

● **Aoun, the preferred candidate of both Riyadh and Washington, was elected after the weakening of Hezbollah and the overthrow of the group's ally Bashar Al Assad in Syria shifted the balance of power in Lebanon.**

travel ban on its citizens and withdrew diplomats from Beirut in solidarity with Saudi Arabia after a Lebanese minister criticised the Riyadh-led Arab military intervention in Yemen.

Lebanese citizens were not banned from travelling to the UAE.

The Abu Dhabi Fund for

Development, which supports infrastructure projects in developing countries, will send a delegation to Lebanon to study potential joint projects, the statement said.

Saudi Arabia's move

In March, Saudi Arabia said it would review "obstacles" to resuming Lebanese imports and ending a ban on its nationals visiting Lebanon.

That announcement came after Aoun met Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammad Bin Salman in Riyadh on his first trip abroad since taking office in January.

Aoun, the preferred candidate of both Riyadh and Washington, was elected after the weakening of Hezbollah and the overthrow of the group's ally Bashar Al Assad in Syria shifted the balance of power in Lebanon.

— AFP

US calls upon India, Pakistan to 'de-escalate'

PAKISTAN URGED TO AID PROBE; DELHI ADVISED TO WORK WITH ISLAMABAD

WASHINGTON

The United States has appealed to India and Pakistan to de-escalate after a deadly attack in Kashmir, as New Delhi yesterday said that both sides again traded border gunfire overnight.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has given his military "complete operational freedom" after the deadly Pahalgam terror attack that killed 26 people on April 22.

Islamabad says it has "credible evidence" that India is now planning an imminent military strike, vowing that "any act of aggression will be met with a decisive response".

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio late Wednesday separately called India's top diplomat Subrahmanyam Jaishankar and Pakistan's Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, the State Department said.

Rubio "urged Pakistani officials' cooperation in investigating this unconscionable attack" and "encouraged India to work with Pakistan to de-escalate tensions and maintain peace and security in South Asia", said spokeswoman Tammy Bruce.

Seeking justice

India's foreign minister said yesterday after the call that the attack's "perpetrators, backers and planners must be brought to justice".

Also yesterday, New Delhi reported the seventh straight night of small arms gunfire

\$23,500

bounty for
information on
suspected attackers

between the two sides at the heavily militarised Line of Control, the de facto border.

Since the attack — the deadliest in Kashmir on civilians in years — India and Pakistan have exchanged tit-for-tat diplomatic barbs and expulsions and shut border crossings.

Indian police have issued wanted posters for three men suspected of involvement who they say belong to the Lashkar-e-Taiba, a UN-designated terrorist organisation.

They have announced a two-million-rupee (\$23,500) bounty for information leading to each man's arrest and carried out sweeping detentions seeking anyone suspected of links to the attackers.

New Delhi on Wednesday closed its airspace to Pakistani planes, after Islamabad banned Indian planes from overflying.

The worst attack in recent years in Kashmir was at Pulwama in 2019, when a suicide bomber rammed a car packed with explosives into a security forces convoy, killing 40 and wounding 35.

Indian fighter jets carried out air strikes on Pakistani territory 12 days later.

— AFP

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SPORT

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Driver with Dh104,730 in traffic fines arrested

He had 137 violations, fake number plates

SHARJAH
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

Sharjah Police have arrested a driver who attempted to evade detection by affixing fake license plates to his vehicle. Advanced surveillance systems flagged the vehicle, revealing a staggering 137 traffic violations totalling Dh104,730. He also accumulated 308 traffic points, and incurred an impoundment period exceeding 764 days.

Legal proceedings are now underway, with all violations officially recorded under the driver's traffic file, and the case has been referred to the Public Prosecution.



Colonel Omar Mohammad Bu Ghanem, Deputy Director of the Traffic and Patrols Department at Sharjah Police, stated that the arrest was the result of close coordination between field patrols and the Control and Monitoring Centre. The vehicle was detected by sophisticated surveillance technology deployed across internal and external roads in the emirate.



Watch:
Sharjah Police use advanced surveillance tech to nab offender

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